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Businesses in ChatGPT: the complete *setup*

Claim your business, get the blue check, fix what ChatGPT knows about you, and read your numbers. Checked against OpenAI's beta launch on November 10, 2026.

hiteshdua.com/guides/chatgpt-business-setup · by Hitesh Dua, @pragmaticcoder.ai · updated November 11, 2026

In one minute

OpenAI launched Businesses in ChatGPT in beta on November 10, 2026. You claim your business in a new Business Hub, get a blue check, correct what ChatGPT says about you, and see how often it mentions you and sends clicks to your site.

- **The reach:** OpenAI says 1.2 billion people use ChatGPT each week.
- **The cost:** free at launch. OpenAI has not ruled out charging later.
- **The extra:** eligible U.S. ecommerce and online service businesses can also publish a Business Agent, an AI chat that answers shoppers from your own information.
- **The limit:** claiming does not move you up. OpenAI says it "does not guarantee higher placement or sales."

Where to go: chatgpt.com/business-hub, or Business Hub in the ChatGPT sidebar.

Before you start

What you can do today depends on your business type. Check your row first.

YOUR BUSINESS	CLAIM A PROFILE	BUSINESS AGENT
Online store (ecommerce), U.S.	Yes	Yes, if eligible
Online service business, U.S.	Yes, where the claim flow offers it	Yes, if eligible
Online business outside the U.S.	Yes, where ChatGPT is available	Not yet
Local store or restaurant, U.S.	Only an existing listing	Not yet
Local store or restaurant, outside the U.S.	Not yet	Not yet

Eligibility also depends on your industry and on OpenAI's verification checks. Some early testers saw the service-business option marked "Coming soon" on launch day.

Have these ready:

- A ChatGPT account for the owner or an authorized representative. A free account works.
- One way to prove the business is yours: the business phone, a business email, access to your domain's DNS, or your Shopify store.
- A government ID, plus business registration details that match your official records.
- Your current hours, contact details, and return and delivery policies.
- A product feed with prices and availability, if you sell products.

Claim and verify

The blue check appears after the identity check is approved, not when the claim is approved. Start both on the same day.

1. **Open Business Hub.** Sign in to ChatGPT, then open Business Hub from the sidebar or go to chatgpt.com/business-hub.
2. **Find your business.** Search by name and select the listing that matches. An eligible online business that is not listed may see an option to add it.
3. **Confirm the account.** Pick the ChatGPT account that will manage the business.
4. **Verify the claim.** Use one of the methods offered for your business:
   - a code sent by text or call to your main business number
   - a code sent to a business email
   - a TXT record added to your domain's DNS, then **Verify domain**
   - **Shopify store**, then **Connect Shopify**
5. **Wait for the review.** OpenAI reviews the claim and emails a decision or a request for more information. Review time varies.
6. **Complete the identity check.** Select **Verify with Persona** and follow the steps. Name, address and registration details must match official records.
7. **Get the blue check.** Once Persona is approved you can publish changes, connect a product feed, view insights and, if eligible, create an agent.

If you see **Contact support**, the listing is locked or already claimed. Each brand and each location needs its own claim.

Fill in your profile

Write the profile the way a customer would ask about you, because this is the information ChatGPT can use when it describes your business.

- **Basics:** business name, category, address or service area, hours, phone and email.
- **What you offer:** a plain description of your products or services, plus your logo.
- **Policies:** return policy and delivery policy. These are the answers shoppers ask for most.
- **Product feed:** retailers can upload a feed with product details, pricing and availability, so prices and stock stay current.
- **Shopify:** connect your store from Business Hub or from the Shopify admin (Sales channels, Agentic, ChatGPT). Eligible products already reach ChatGPT through Shopify Catalog.

Two cautions before you publish. A published profile cannot be hidden by support, so check every detail first. And keep the same name, address, hours and prices on your website and your Google Business Profile, so sources agree.

Build a Business Agent

A Business Agent is a labeled AI chat that speaks for your business inside ChatGPT. It is open to eligible ecommerce and online service businesses in the United States, and verification alone does not guarantee access.

How shoppers reach it: your business appears in a ChatGPT answer, they open your profile, and they start a separate chat with your agent. That chat is labeled and kept apart from ChatGPT's own answers.

1. **Give it your facts.** Add product information, policies and instructions. The agent answers from what you supply.
2. **Test it before launch.** Ask what customers ask, such as whether a sale item can be returned. If the answer is wrong, fix the source information, not the wording.
3. **Publish it** from Business Hub once the answers hold up.
4. **Optional: sponsor it.** A Business Agent can be the destination for ChatGPT Ads. Sponsored placements are labeled.

Rules OpenAI sets for agents:

- It must say it is an AI that represents your business.
- It must not invent offers, prices, availability, reviews or guarantees.
- No false urgency, and no pushing after someone declines.
- It must not ask for health details, government IDs or financial credentials.
- At launch it explains and links to your site. It does not complete purchases, take bookings or check orders.

Read your insights

Open your business in Business Hub and select **Insights**. The numbers cover the last 28 days and are aggregated, so you never see individual chats.

METRIC	WHAT IT COUNTS	WATCH OUT FOR
Mentions	Online business: answers that reference your website. Local business: answers that show a result for your location.	Your brand name alone does not count for an online business.
Website clicks	Recorded clicks on links to your website in ChatGPT.	Clicks do not confirm visits or conversions.
Discovery topics	The top themes in conversations where your site is cited.	Themes only. No prompts, no competitors.

A blank metric can mean your activity is below the reporting threshold, not zero. OpenAI does not publish the threshold.

A weekly habit that pays off:

- Log the three numbers in your own sheet each week. The window is 28 days and history is not kept for you.
- Turn each discovery topic into a page or a profile line that answers it plainly.
- Compare website clicks with chatgpt.com referrals in your own analytics.

ChatGPT vs Google Business Profile

Keep both. Google Business Profile puts you on the map; Businesses in ChatGPT puts you in the answer and lets you answer back.

	GOOGLE BUSINESS PROFILE	BUSINESSES IN CHATGPT
Where you show up	Google Search and Maps	Inside ChatGPT answers
What customers do	Call, get directions, read reviews, visit your site	Ask, compare, open your profile, chat with your agent
What you control	Hours, photos, posts, replies to reviews	Business details, policies, product feed, your agent's information
What you measure	Views, calls, direction requests, website clicks	Mentions, website clicks, discovery topics
Best fit today	Local businesses that serve customers in person	Online stores first; local limited to existing U.S. listings
Reach	Google Maps: 2 billion+ monthly users (Google)	ChatGPT: 1.2 billion weekly users (OpenAI)
Cost	Free	Free at launch
Status	Established	Beta since Nov 10, 2026

The two reach figures use different units, monthly and weekly, so read them as scale, not as a head-to-head.

The fine print

This is a beta, and these limits were true at launch on November 10, 2026.

- **No ranking boost.** Claiming gives you accurate information and data. ChatGPT still makes its own recommendations.
- **Local is narrow.** Local stores and restaurants can claim only an existing U.S. listing for now.
- **Agents are U.S. only.** Business Agents start with eligible U.S. ecommerce and online service businesses.
- **Free for now.** No price is listed for claiming or for Business Hub. ChatGPT Ads is a separate, paid product.
- **One claim per brand and location.** There is no central management for multiple brands or locations yet.
- **Privacy.** OpenAI says it does not share users' conversations or Business Agent chats with businesses.
- **Still unknown.** The reporting threshold for insights, the full list of eligible industries, and dates for more markets.

Checklist

- [ ] Check which row of the eligibility table fits your business
- [ ] Gather ID, registration details, hours, policies and product feed
- [ ] Open Business Hub and find your listing
- [ ] Verify by phone, email, DNS record or Shopify
- [ ] Complete the Persona identity check the same day
- [ ] Fill in basics, description, logo and policies, then publish
- [ ] Connect your product feed or Shopify store
- [ ] If eligible, build, test and publish your Business Agent
- [ ] Match your details across your website and Google Business Profile
- [ ] Log mentions, clicks and topics every week

Sources

Read for this guide on November 10 and 11, 2026:

- Search Engine Roundtable: Businesses in ChatGPT Business Hub live with click data (https://www.seroundtable.com/chatgpt-business-hub-42505.html)
- The Keyword: ChatGPT opens business profiles and agents to brands (https://www.thekeyword.co/news/chatgpt-business-hub-agents)
- Citeme: Businesses in ChatGPT, claim flow tested on launch day (https://www.citeme.io/ressources/businesses-in-chatgpt)
- CellCog: Businesses in ChatGPT, how to claim your business (https://cellcog.ai/blog/businesses-in-chatgpt/)
- Hans van Gent: what Business Hub's visibility numbers count (https://hansvangent.substack.com/p/chatgpt-business-hub)

OpenAI's own pages, which the coverage above quotes. Check them before you start, since a beta changes:

- OpenAI: Introducing Businesses in ChatGPT (https://openai.com/index/introducing-businesses-chatgpt/)
- OpenAI: Businesses in ChatGPT product page (https://openai.com/business/businesses-in-chatgpt/)
- OpenAI Help Center: Setting up your business on ChatGPT (https://help.openai.com/en/articles/20001635-setting-up-your-business-on-chatgpt)
- OpenAI: Business Agents policy (https://openai.com/policies/business-agents-policy/)
- Shopify Help Center: Selling on ChatGPT (https://help.shopify.com/en/manual/online-sales-channels/agentic-storefronts/chatgpt)